Phase 0: Setup and Source Inventory

Case Study: Mulago National Referral Hospital

Mulago National Referral Hospital

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1. Introduction

We will role-play a walkthrough of Mulago National Referral Hospital in Kampala, Uganda, to identify the sources of data used in its operations.

Mulago provides paediatric care, surgical services, internal medicine, laboratory services, radiology, emergency care and administrative services. These departments provide a realistic basis for examining the hospital's data sources.

Important: This is a simulated walkthrough, not a physical visit or an interview with hospital staff. The hospital's services are publicly documented, but the specific systems, data volumes, owners and data quality ratings below are illustrative assumptions for the project.

2. Simulated walkthrough

Imagine we begin at the patient assessment and registration area and proceed through the hospital.

- **Patient registration:** We investigate how patient identities and demographic details are recorded.
- **Outpatient and inpatient services:** We examine where consultations, diagnoses and admission records originate.
- **Laboratory and radiology:** We identify sources of test requests and diagnostic results.
- **Pharmacy:** We investigate how prescriptions and medicine dispensing are recorded.
- **Accounts:** We examine sources of billing and payment information.
- **Administration:** We identify staff and operational records used to manage hospital activities.

3. Source inventory table

The following table is our **preliminary inventory based on the simulated walkthrough**. The volume and quality ratings are working estimates, not measured findings.

No.	Data source/system	Data owner	Format	Estimated volume	Quality reputation
1	Patient registration records	Patient Records Officer	Electronic database or paper forms	Very high	Good
2	Outpatient records	Outpatient Department Records Officer	Electronic records or paper registers	Very high	Good
3	Inpatient and admission records	Inpatient Records Officer	Electronic records or paper files	High	Fair
4	Laboratory information and test records	Laboratory Manager	Laboratory system or paper records	High	Good
5	Radiology and imaging records	Radiology Department Manager	Digital imaging system and reports	High	Good
6	Pharmacy and medicine dispensing records	Pharmacy Manager	Pharmacy system or dispensing registers	High	Good
7	Billing and payment records	Accounts Officer	Accounting system, spreadsheets or receipts	High	Fair
8	Appointment and clinic attendance records	Outpatient Administration	Booking system, registers or spreadsheets	High	Fair
9	Staff and human resource records	Human Resources Manager	HR system or personnel files	Moderate	Fair
10	Procurement and inventory records	Procurement Officer	Inventory system, spreadsheets or paper documents	Moderate to high	Fair
11	Emergency department records	Emergency Department Records Officer	Electronic records or paper forms	High	Good
12	Monthly clinical and operational reports	Hospital Planning or Records Department	Spreadsheets, databases or reports	Moderate	Good

Interpretation of the columns:

- **Data owner:** The proposed role accountable for the source. The actual person or formally designated owner has not been verified.
- **Format:** Possible formats to confirm during the simulated walkthrough.
- **Volume:** A qualitative estimate of the likely scale of records.
- **Quality reputation:** Assumed for project but *Unknown* because we have not inspected the data or interviewed the responsible staff.